GUIDE 12 · QUERIES

Export a Postman collection for a set of APIs

The latest version is at anantharajuc.github.io/QueryAPIGate-website/Guide.dc.html?g=12-export-a-postman-collection. This copy was made on 4 November 2026.

Time: 2 minutes. **You'll end up with:** a real, importable Postman Collection (v2.1) covering every saved query in a collection - correct URLs, example parameter values, and documentation per field - that you can hand to a teammate without them writing a single request by hand.

From the admin UI

Open **API Repository**, click **Collections**, pick a collection, then click **Postman** (next to the key count and **Rename**, in the collection's own query list) - downloads a `.json` file ready to import into Postman (File → Import).

Over the API

```shell
curl http://127.0.0.1:5000/api/v1/collections/catalog/postman -H 'X-API-Key: demo-key' -o
catalog.postman_collection.json
```

Admin only - verified: a scoped key gets the same "not authorized to manage the server configuration" error every other admin-only endpoint gives. An empty or nonexistent collection name is a clean 404 (`"Collection 'does-not-exist' not found"`).

What's actually in the file, verified against a real export

```json
{
  "info": {"name": "catalog", "schema":
"https://schema.getpostman.com/json/collection/v2.1.0/collection.json",
           "description": "...Set the apiKey variable to a key that may run them."},
  "auth": {"type": "apikey", "apikey": [{"key": "key", "value": "X-API-Key", "type": "string"},
                                        {"key": "value", "value": "{{apiKey}}", "type": "string"},
                                        {"key": "in", "value": "header", "type": "string"}]},
  "variable": [{"key": "baseUrl", "value": "http://127.0.0.1:5000"}, {"key": "apiKey", "value": ""}],
  "item": [ /* one request per saved query */ ]
}
```

No credential is ever in the file - `apiKey` is a collection variable left blank, for whoever imports it to fill in themselves in Postman. `baseUrl` is picked up from whatever host you actually requested the export from - verified: exporting from `http://127.0.0.1:5000` produced exactly that as `baseUrl`, not a hardcoded value.

Each query becomes a real, runnable request with sensible example values, derived from the parameter's own validation rules - verified against two real saved queries:

PARAMETER'S RULES	EXAMPLE VALUE POSTMAN GETS
`"enum": ["tools", "electronics"]`	`tools` - the first enum value
`"default": 10`	that default
`"min": 1` (no default)	`1`
`"pattern": "[A-Za-z%]+"`	left **empty**, with the description `must match /[A-Za-z%]+/ - fill this in` - there's no safe way to synthesize a string that matches an arbitrary regex, so this is the one honest exception

Every optional parameter is added to the request but **disabled** by default (Postman shows it, doesn't send it, until you check the box) - including `format` / `page` / `page_size`, added to every request the same way regardless of the query's own parameters, each with a one-line description of what it does.

What's not included

- **Mongo saved queries are silently skipped** - verified: a Mongo query filed in the same collection as two SQL queries simply doesn't appear in the exported `item` list, no error, no placeholder. Postman export only understands SQL saved queries today.
- **It's a snapshot of the latest version, not a live link** - the collection's own description says so explicitly ("export again after queries change"). Editing a saved query afterward doesn't update anyone's already-imported file.
- **Nothing from a different collection, or an uncollected query** - exactly the queries filed under the one collection name you asked for; see Group queries into a collection if you haven't organized yours into one yet.

Next steps

- Group queries into a collection - if the queries you want to share aren't filed under one yet.
- Set up your first scoped API key - the key your teammate pastes into Postman's `apiKey` variable should usually be a scoped one, not the admin key.